共享单车

校门口的一个小计划

Shared Bikes

A small plan for the school gate

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Footnotes mark names, festival terms and words above HSK 3 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 在中国的城市里，走到哪儿都能看到共享单车[†]。它们有黄色的、蓝色的、绿色的，一排一排地停在路边。许娜[‡]是一个大学二年级的学生。她常常说："除了吃饭和睡觉以外，我每天用得最多的就是共享单车。"

扫[§]一扫

2 许娜的大学离地铁站不远，走路要二十分钟，骑车只要五分钟。每天早上出了地铁，她就拿出手机，打开共享单车的软件[¶]，扫一扫车上的二维码[*]。很快，车就能骑了。到了学校门口，她把车停好，关上锁[#]，手机上马上就会告诉她：这次骑了六分钟，一块五。

3 许娜觉得，共享单车不仅便宜，而且非常方便。你不用自己买车，也不用自己修车。

† 共享单车 *gòngxiǎng dānchē* shared bike
‡ 许娜 *Xǔ Nà* Xu Na
§ 扫 *sǎo* to scan
¶ 软件 *ruǎnjiàn* app
* 二维码 *èrwéimǎ* QR code
锁 *suǒ* lock

In Chinese cities, you see shared bikes wherever you go. They come in yellow, blue and green, parked row after row along the roads. Xu Na is a second-year university student. She often says, "Apart from eating and sleeping, the thing I use most every day is a shared bike." 1

Scan and Ride

Xu Na's university is not far from the subway station: twenty minutes on foot, only five by bike. Every morning, as soon as she comes out of the subway, she takes out her phone, opens the bike app and scans the QR code on a bike. In no time, the bike is ready to ride. At the school gate she parks the bike and snaps the lock shut, and her phone tells her at once: six minutes this time, one yuan fifty. 2

Xu Na thinks shared bikes are not only cheap but also really convenient. You don't have to buy a bike yourself, or repair one either. 3

只要手机里有钱，走到哪儿都能找到一辆车，骑到哪儿就可以停在哪儿。除了上课以外，周末她还常常和朋友一起骑车去湖边玩儿。

许娜[†]还记得，她上小学的时候，街上的共享单车[‡]越来越多，颜色也越来越多。那是2017年前后，很多公司都想做这个生意，城市里的车一年比一年多。据说，那时候全国有两千多万辆共享单车。可是车太多了，问题也就来了。

门口的车山

那时候，在有的城市，路边、地铁站门口、公园外面，到处都是车。很多车被放在一起，像一座小山，人们叫它“车山”。这些车不仅让走路的人很不方便，而且很多都坏了，没有人修，也没有人管。

† 许娜 *Xǔ Nà* Xu Na

‡ 共享单车 *gòngxiǎng dānchē* shared bike

As long as there's money on your phone, you can find a bike wherever you are, and leave it wherever you end up. Besides riding to class, she often cycles to the lake with friends at the weekend. 3

Xu Na remembers that when she was in primary school there were more and more shared bikes on the streets, in more and more colours. That was around 2017. Lots of companies wanted a piece of the business, and every year there were more bikes in the cities than the year before. It is said that at the time there were more than twenty million shared bikes across the country. But with too many bikes came problems. 4

The Bike Mountain at the Gate

In some cities back then, there were bikes everywhere: along the roads, outside subway stations, by the parks. Heaps of bikes were piled up together like small hills, and people called them "bike mountains". These bikes didn't just get in the way of people on foot; many of them were broken, and nobody repaired them or took charge of them. 5

后来，城市开始管了：在路边画出停车的地方，车只能停在白线里面；公司也不能想放多少车就放多少了。慢慢地，街上比以前整齐多了。

可是，许娜[†]学校的门口还是很乱。学校规定，共享单车[‡]不能骑进学校，所以大家都把车停在门口。每天早上七点半到八点半，几百个学生从地铁站骑过来，每个人都想离门口近一点儿。车一辆一辆地停下来，有的停在路中间，有的倒在地上。到了八点多，门口就有了一座自己的“车山”。

一个下雨的早上，许娜到学校门口的时候，看见一位老奶奶带着一个小孩子，站在车山前面，走不过去。老奶奶想从旁边走，一辆车突然倒了下来，正好倒在孩子的脚边。孩子大哭了起来。许娜赶快跑过去，把车拿开，又帮老奶奶搬开了好几辆车。老奶奶说：“谢谢你啊，姑娘。这些车骑的时候很方便，停的时候就不方便别人了。”

† 许娜 *Xǔ Nà* Xu Na

‡ 共享单车 *gòngxiǎng dānchē* shared bike

Later the cities stepped in. They painted parking spaces along the roads, and bikes could only be left inside the white lines; companies could no longer put out as many bikes as they liked. Little by little, the streets became much tidier than before. 5

But the gate of Xu Na's university was still a mess. The university's rules said shared bikes couldn't be ridden onto campus, so everyone left them at the gate. Every morning between half past seven and half past eight, hundreds of students rode over from the subway station, and each of them wanted to stop as close to the gate as possible. The bikes came to a stop one after another; some were left in the middle of the road, some lay fallen on the ground. By a little after eight, the gate had a "bike mountain" of its own. 6

One rainy morning, when Xu Na reached the gate, she saw an old woman with a small child standing in front of the bike mountain, unable to get past. The old woman tried to go round the side, and a bike suddenly toppled over, landing right by the child's feet. The child burst into tears. Xu Na hurried over, moved the bike out of the way, and helped the old woman shift several more. "Thank you, dear," said the old woman. "These bikes are handy when you ride them, but the way they're parked makes life hard for everyone else." 7

7 许娜[†]把这句话记了很久。

我们的办法

8 那天中午吃饭的时候，许娜把这件事告诉了两个好朋友：王磊[‡]和林小雨[§]。王磊学数学，最喜欢数字；林小雨学设计，画画儿画得特别好。王磊说："门口这么乱，学校为什么不管？"林小雨说："门外面是马路，不是学校里面，学校可能也不好管。"许娜想了想，说："那我们先自己想个办法，再交给学校，怎么样？"

9 接下来的一个星期，三个人每天早上七点就到门口。王磊拿着本子数车：七点半有一百多辆，八点有两百多辆，八点半的时候有三百多辆。他还发现，除了早上以外，别的时候门口的车都不太多。

† 许娜 *Xǔ Nà* Xu Na

‡ 王磊 *Wáng Lěi* Wang Lei

§ 林小雨 *Lín Xiǎoyǔ* Lin Xiaoyu

Xu Na remembered those words for a long time. 7

Our Plan

At lunch that day, Xu Na told two good friends about it: Wang Lei and Lin Xiaoyu. Wang Lei studied maths and loved numbers; Lin Xiaoyu studied design and was especially good at drawing. "The gate's such a mess," said Wang Lei. "Why doesn't the university do something?" "Outside the gate is the street, not the campus," said Lin Xiaoyu. "Maybe it's hard for the university to deal with." Xu Na thought for a moment. "Then why don't we come up with a plan ourselves first, and then hand it to the university?" 8

For the next week, the three of them were at the gate by seven every morning. Wang Lei counted the bikes with a notebook in hand: over a hundred at half past seven, over two hundred at eight, and over three hundred by half past eight. He also found that, apart from the mornings, there were never very many bikes at the gate. 9

9 林小雨[†]在旁边拍照片，还把门口画成了一张地图。许娜[‡]去问骑车的同学：“如果停车的地方离门口远五十米，你愿意吗？”大部分同学都说：“只要有地方停，远一点儿也没关系。”

10 一个星期以后，他们的计划写好了。第一，在门口东边的一块地上画一个大的停车区，路中间不能停车。第二，请同学们当志愿者，每天早上在门口帮大家把车停整齐。第三，请单车公司每天早上派人来，把多的车拉走。林小雨还画了一个很好看的牌子，上面写着：“多走二十步，大家都方便。”

11 他们把计划交给了负责学生生活的刘[§]老师。刘老师看了很久，说：“你们的计划不仅写得很清楚，而且有数字、有地图，很有用。”“门口的马路不是学校管的，不过我可以帮你们联系城市里管马路的人和单车公司。”

† 林小雨 *Lín Xiǎoyǔ* Lin Xiaoyu
‡ 许娜 *Xǔ Nà* Xu Na
§ 刘 *Liú* Liu (surname)

Lin Xiaoyu took photos nearby and drew a map of the gate. Xu Na asked the students who rode in: "If the parking place were fifty metres further from the gate, would you be OK with that?" Most of them said, "As long as there's somewhere to park, a bit further is fine." 9

A week later, their plan was written. First, mark out a large parking area on a patch of ground east of the gate, with no parking in the middle of the road. Second, ask students to volunteer, helping everyone park neatly at the gate each morning. Third, ask the bike companies to send someone every morning to take away the extra bikes. Lin Xiaoyu also designed a nice-looking sign. It read: "Walk twenty more steps, and make life easier for everyone." 10

They gave the plan to Mr Liu, the teacher in charge of student life. Mr Liu read it for a long time. "Your plan isn't just clearly written," he said. "It has numbers and a map too. It's really useful." "The road outside isn't the university's to manage, but I can help you get in touch with the people in the city who look after it, and with the bike companies." 11

11 许娜[†]他们高兴得跳了起来。

一个月以后

12 两个星期以后，门口东边的地上真的画出了白线。除了白线以外，旁边还放了林小雨[‡]画的牌子。单车公司也改了软件[§]：如果车不停在白线里面，手机上就不能还车，还要多付钱。有二十多个同学报名当志愿者，许娜每天早上都在门口帮大家停车。第一个星期，门口比以前干净多了，路中间一辆车也没有。

13 可是，不是所有的事情都像计划里写的那样。有的同学怕上课晚了，还是把车停在门口就跑进了学校。天气越来越冷，来帮忙的志愿者也越来越少，有一天早上只有许娜一个人。单车公司说好每天早上派人来，可是有时候九点多才来。

† 许娜 *Xǔ Nà* Xu Na

‡ 林小雨 *Lín Xiǎoyǔ* Lin Xiaoyu

§ 软件 *ruǎnjiàn* app

Xu Na and her friends jumped for joy. 11

A Month Later

Two weeks later, white lines really were painted on the ground east of the gate. Besides the white lines, Lin Xiaoyu's sign was put up next to them. The bike companies changed their app too: if a bike wasn't parked inside the lines, you couldn't return it on your phone, and you had to pay extra. More than twenty students signed up as volunteers, and Xu Na was at the gate every morning helping people park. In the first week the gate was far tidier than before, with not a single bike in the middle of the road. 12

But not everything went the way the plan said. Some students, afraid of being late for class, still dropped their bikes at the gate and ran inside. As the weather grew colder, fewer and fewer volunteers came to help; one morning Xu Na was there all by herself. The bike companies had promised to send someone every morning, but sometimes nobody turned up until after nine. 13

13 王磊[†]有点儿生气：“这样下去，门口又要变成车山了！”

14 许娜[‡]也有点儿累，可是她发现，门口的人也在慢慢改变。越来越多的同学不用别人说，自己就把车停进了白线里。有一次，她看见一个男生停好自己的车以后，又把旁边倒在地上的两辆车也放好了。

15 一个月以后，王磊又数了一次：早上八点半，停在白线外面的车从三百多辆变成了三十多辆。“还是有三十多辆啊。”王磊说。“可是以前有三百多辆呢。”林小雨[§]笑着说。这个计划不仅让门口变干净了，而且让他们三个人认识了很多新朋友。

16 那天早上，许娜又看见了那位老奶奶。

† 王磊 *Wáng Lěi* Wang Lei
‡ 许娜 *Xǔ Nà* Xu Na
§ 林小雨 *Lín Xiǎoyǔ* Lin Xiaoyu

Wang Lei got a bit cross. "If this goes on, the gate's going to turn back into a bike mountain!" 13

Xu Na was a bit tired too, but she noticed that the people at the gate were slowly changing as well. More and more students parked inside the lines on their own, without anyone having to tell them. Once she saw a boy park his own bike and then set upright two bikes that had fallen over beside it. 14

A month later Wang Lei counted again: at half past eight in the morning, the bikes parked outside the lines had gone from over three hundred to just over thirty. "There are still over thirty," said Wang Lei. "But there used to be over three hundred," said Lin Xiaoyu with a smile. The plan had not only cleared the gate; it had also brought the three of them a lot of new friends. 15

That morning Xu Na saw the old woman again. 16

16 她带着那个孩子，从门口慢慢地走了过去，路上一辆车也没有。老奶奶看见许娜†，笑了笑。许娜想：共享单车‡是大家的，门口的路也是大家的。只要每个人多走二十步，大家就都方便了。

† 许娜 *Xǔ Nà* Xu Na

‡ 共享单车 *gòngxiǎng dānchē* shared bike

She walked slowly past the gate with the same child, and not a single bike stood in their way. The old woman saw Xu Na and smiled. Xu Na thought: the shared bikes belong to everyone, and so does the road at the gate. As long as each person walks twenty more steps, life is easier for everyone. 16